

CREDENTIALS · SOLO DESIGN · 2025

A Product Page That Tells You Which Sustainability Claims To Trust

TIMELINE	ROLE	METHOD	TOOLS
2026	End-to-end UI/UX designer (solo)	Product teardown, user interviews, journey mapping, IA prototyping	Figma, Figjam

TL;DR

Shoppers who want to buy sustainably can't tell which claims to trust. Product pages stack specs, badges, and marketing claims at the same visual weight, so five minutes of reading leaves you no closer to knowing what matters.

Sometime turns that into one moment. Scan a product, get a Verified Score split into Human Trust, Sourcing Impact, and Supply Chain Integrity—each independently understandable. Where a claim can't be verified yet, the score says so instead of rounding up.

RESEARCH	DESIGN	STATUS
Teardown of a live product page. Four user interviews and an on-stage observation. Competitive analysis of nine Sun product statements and four design grails.	High-fidelity screens for the scan entry point, the At a Glance score, the Ingredient Breakdown, and the Brand Claims verification split. Built solo, end to end.	Concept project. Designed and ready to build, not yet validated with users. Next step is a moderated test to see what would prove it.

BRIEF

Design an e-commerce experience that makes health- and environment-conscious buying decisions simple and transparent.

CHALLENGE

How might a product page make sustainability claims verifiable at a glance, instead of handing shoppers a pile of claims and expecting them to check it alone?

SOLUTION

Three screens carry the idea. Here's what each one does.



One score, not five scattered signals.

The page leads with a single Verified Score, split into Human Trust, Sourcing Impact, and Supply Chain Integrity. Shoppers see what to check first instead of guessing.



Plain-language ingredients, no detour required.

Fifteen ingredients, sorted by concentration, each explained in one sentence, on the page. No jump to Alexa or a separate chat window.



Brand claims and verified data, kept visibly apart.

Every claim is tagged Brand-reported or AI-analyzed. Shoppers know which one to trust, and why.

THE PROBLEM

I pulled apart a live product page for a cleaning product and walked it the way a shopper would. Four things broke.



Every entry point promises a different kind of truth, so none of them earn trust.

Search bar, question chips, a leaf badge, an Alexa icon. Four paths to the same answer. The badge carries no score or certification, but it's tagged a verb the page into a chat window.



More information isn't more trust. It's more to verify.

Specs, claims, ingredient callouts, and suggested questions all carry the same visual weight. A shopper scanning for five minutes still can't tell which claim to check first.



The purchase moment optimizes for urgency, not the habits it claims to support.

One-time purchase and Subscribe & Save sit side by side, with the subscription framed as the lower-earning option. Thirty $1 left in stock pushes for speed instead. Refill and impact info sits in a separate card, outside the buy box, so it never enters the decision.



Reviews tell you if it worked, not whether the claims are true.

Four stars, a shelf and streaks, not whether a "safe chemicals" claim holds up. The page hands shoppers a pile of claims and expects them to verify it alone.

WHY A SCORE

The teardown ruled out the badge before it drew anything.

The failure on the live page wasn't a missing signal. It was an unchecked one: a leaf icon with no score, no certification, and no comparison behind it. Adding another badge repeats the problem. A score has to mean its parts, and the parts have to be designed. Three named categories, each traceable to a source.

INITIAL FINDINGS

But why fix the product page and not search, or checkout?

Because that's where the decision gets made. Mapping six stages, from first discovery to after-sale, showed browsing and product research carrying every trust question. Search sends people to the page. Checkout only confirms what they already decided.

People aren't unwilling to check. The checking is just too expensive.

Four interviews, across a range of interest in sustainability. Nobody rejected sustainable products. They rejected the effort of verifying them.



The trust questions all cluster in one place.

Six stages, mapped with context points, user actions, and pain points at each. Discovery and browsing raise the questions. Product research is where shoppers try and fail to answer them. That's the stage worth designing for.

Stage	Discovery	Browsing	Product Research	Purchase	Logistics	After Sale Services
Context / Feeling	• Social media, influencer, or friend recommendation • Regret & Routine • Search engine • Sustainable Marketplace	• Environmentally conscious • Health-conscious • Performance-driven • Price-sensitive	• Product page • Ingredient, LCA, certification • Comparison sites	• Shopping cart • Payment options	• Express Delivery • Delivery options	• Maintenance & Repair • Customer support • Warranty & Return policies
User Actions	Scrolling, email to friend, clicking on ad, searching for product	Comparing products, reading reviews, checking ingredients, looking for certifications	Evaluating the product, reading reviews, checking ingredients, looking for certifications	Checking cart, applying discount code, choosing payment method	Tracking the order, choosing the delivery option	Using the product, contacting support, leaving a review, returning the product
Pain points	Too much unrelated noise/content from social media, hard to find a relevant product	Too many options, unclear on which is truly sustainable, overwhelming information	Some pages just list unverifiable claims, hard to find reliable information, unclear on which is truly sustainable	Unexpected shipping costs, limited payment options	No guidance on proper use, unclear on how to maintain	Product gathers dust, unsure how to recycle, difficult to contact support

GOAL

Give the page one visible hierarchy.

Specs, badges, and callouts carry equal weight, so nothing tells the shopper what to check first.

Explain claims in plain language, in place.

Jargon pushes people off the page to ask Alexa or search elsewhere, which builds no trust.

Make claims verifiable, not just visible.

Trust currently rests on reviews and influencer content, neither of which can confirm a company's claim.

Put the sustainable option in the path of the purchase decision.

Refill will not outside the buy box, so urgency wins by default. This is the one goal I didn't get to. See Reflection.

THE BUSINESS CASE

Transparency only differentiates if it's checkable.

Brands already compete on sustainability claims. The teardown shows what that competition currently looks like, which is a leaf badge with nothing behind it. A brand with real data has no way to look different from a brand that's overstating. Sometime gives the honest one a surface where the difference is visible.

The revenue model and the score put against each other.

If brands pay to be scored, the thing judging them has a reason to be generous. I designed against that before I had a solution for it. Every claim is tagged Brand-reported or AI-analyzed, and undisclosed categories stay undisclosed instead of rounding up. The label is the safeguard. Whether it holds under commercial pressure is an open question and it's the first thing I'd stress-test with a real brand.

BEFORE / AFTER

BEFORE	AFTER
Four separate trust signals, none of them scored, all competing for attention.	**One Verified Score at the top of the page, broken into three named categories.**
BEFORE	**AFTER**
Ingredient names with no explanation, so understanding them means leaving the page.	**Fifteen ingredients by concentration, each with a one-sentence explanation in place.**
BEFORE	**AFTER**
Brand claims and third-party certifications look identical, so neither can be checked.	**Each claim tagged Brand-reported or AI-analyzed, with the source attached.**

OUTCOME

Three of four goals designed, none validated yet.

The scan entry point, the At a Glance score, the ingredient breakdown, and the claim verification split all work as high-fidelity screens. The fourth goal, putting the sustainable option inside the purchase decision, didn't make this pass.

What would prove it.

The bet is that a single scored hierarchy changes what shoppers check first. Testing it means putting the original page and this one in front of the same people and watching where they look, in what order, and how long before they give up. Until then it's a design bet, not a result.

REFLECTION

WHAT I'D CARRY INTO THE NEXT PROJECT

Map the journey before touching a screen.

Interviews told me people wanted help. The journey map told me where to put it. Without that step I'd have redesigned a product page, which raises the question but never answers it.

An unverifiable claim needs its own state, not a zero.

Categories with no disclosed data currently read as 0%, the same as a genuine failure. That quietly undersells the whole promise of the score. It needs a distinct "Not disclosed" treatment.

One number, one source of truth.

The At a Glance card and the Ingredient breakdown show different sub-scores for the same product. Two screens, two answers, which is exactly the problem I set out to fix.

I never tested a simpler format against this one.

A single letter grade would be faster to read and easier to remember than three categories. I didn't prototype one, so I can't claim the score wins. That comparison is the first thing I'd run.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY NEW WITH AI

Pressure-test the score with real data first.

I designed the score with clean sample values. I'd now generate a spread of messy cases — missing fields, partial disclosures, conflicting certifications — and run them through the layout before calling it done.

Synthesize interviews faster, spend the time on the map.

Four transcripts took longer to code than the journey map that came out of them. I'd use AI to synthesize with AI and put the saved hours into more journey maps and more teardowns.

ALSO CHECKOUT

THE FAMILY TABLE · SOLO DESIGN · 2025

A Weekly Family Meal Everyone Wants To Be Part Of

BILLY & BUDDY · SERVICE DESIGN

A Mini Game That Teaches Kids To Tell A Need From A Want, In Two Minutes

Intro
TL;DR
Brief
Challenge
Solution
The Problem
Why a Score
Initial Findings
Goal
The Business Case
Before / After
Outcome
Reflection